

Plants for evergreen effects

Providing a permanent stage for seasonal stars, evergreens have special value in small gardens, and help create continuity during lulls.

Although many are quiet and unassuming, in combination, evergreens with contrasting textures, shapes, and colors can make beautiful displays of their own. For example, large, handlike fatsia leaves, variegated holly foliage, and feathery ferns make an elegant combination for a shady garden. When creating a new planting scheme, place your evergreens first to provide a permanent framework for your design. Also check heights and spreads to ensure that they do not block seasonal plants and flowers or, if they are small and compact like hebe, that adjacent perennials won't swamp them in summer.



SHRUB LARGE

Arbutus unedo

STRAWBERRY TREE Plant this evergreen shrub in a sheltered garden in fertile soil for the best foliage effects through the year. It has dark green leathery leaves and white urn-shaped flowers that appear in fall alongside red, strawberry-like fruits.

↑↔25ft (8m)

☀️ ☀️ 🌿 Z7-9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Blechnum spicant

DEER FERN Perfect for evergreen color and texture, this fern forms low arching hummocks of divided, stiff leathery leaves, with narrow leaflets, and thrives in deep shade. The upright spore-bearing fronds resemble fish bones.

↑30in (75cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️ 🌿 Z5-8 (N)



SHRUB MEDIUM

Buxus sempervirens 'Elegantissima'

COMMON BOXWOOD A compact evergreen shrub with oval white-margined green leaves ideal for low hedges, topiary shapes, or dots of color in a bed. Clip topiary and hedges in early- and late summer.

↑↔5ft (1.5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ 🌿 Z6-8



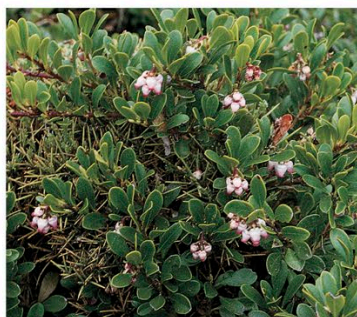
TREE SMALL

Abies nordmanniana 'Golden Spreader'

NORDMANN FIR Brighten up borders with this slow-growing conifer that has spreading branches of golden-yellow needlelike leaves. For year-round color, combine it with dark green- and blue-green-leaved evergreens.

↑3ft (1m) ↔5ft (1.5m)

☀️ ☀️ 🌿 Z4-6



SHRUB SMALL

Arctostaphylos uva-ursi

BEARBERRY Grow this small low-growing evergreen shrub at the front of a bed in acidic soil. The oval dark green leaves, pink-tinted white summer flowers, and round scarlet fall fruits provide year-round interest.

↑4in (10cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ 🌿 Z2-6 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

Bergenia purpurascens

PURPLE BERGENIA This clump-forming, evergreen perennial has large, rounded, glossy green leaves and, in spring, spikes of dark pink blooms. Plant near the front of a bed, and remove tired or damaged leaves to keep it tidy.

↑16in (40cm) ↔24in (60cm) or more

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-8



SHRUB SMALL

Calluna vulgaris

SCOTCH HEATHER The tiny gray, yellow, or bright green leaves of this bushy evergreen shrub liven up bed edges given acidic soil and full sun. From midsummer to late fall, pink, white, and purple bell-shaped flowers appear. Survives cold with protection.

↑12in (30cm) ↔14in (35cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ 🌿 Z4-6



TREE MEDIUM

Chamaecyparis pisifera 'Filifera Aurea'

SAWARA CYPRESS Use this slow-growing evergreen conifer as a colorful textured specimen with blue-leaved conifers in a mixed display. It makes a mound of weeping stems with golden-yellow scaly leaves.

↑40ft (12m) ↔15ft (5m)

☀️ ☀️ Z4-8